



Product Discovery Certification Course

Exam Study Guide

Table of Contents

Introduction	Page 3
Exam details	Page 4
Tips to prepare for the exam	Page 5
Course quick guide	Page 6

Product Discovery Certification Course Exam Study Guide

We're excited that you're interested in making your product discovery knowledge and skills official!

The Product Discovery Certification Course dives deep into the fundamentals of product discovery, how to leverage AI at each stage, ways to scale your strategy, and why product discovery is key to product—and business—success.

At this point, you've likely completed the course and are ready to take the exam. By taking and passing the exam, you'll be able to show that you've learned how to implement and optimize a data-driven product discovery process that results in positive business impact.

This study guide provides an overview of the Product Discovery Certification Course exam and how to best prepare for it. The guide includes:

- ◆ Details about the exam
- ◆ Topics covered
- ◆ Tips to prepare for the exam
- ◆ Course quick guide
 - ◇ Product Discovery Framework
 - ◇ Data-driven Product Discovery Checklist

EXAM DETAILS

Format: 20 multiple choice questions

Time allotted: 60 minutes

Passing score: 75%

Number of attempts: Five

Cost: Free, includes the course as well as the exam

Delivery method: Online, not proctored

Language: English

Prerequisites: None, though we highly recommend that you take the Product Discovery Certification Course to prepare for the exam

TOPICS COVERED IN THE EXAM

The questions on the exam align to the material covered in the Product Discovery Certification Course, and are similar in nature to the end-of-module quiz questions. The topics and percentage of questions per topic on the exam are outlined below.

TOPIC	% OF TOTAL EXAM
Why we need to get product discovery right	20%
Product discovery fundamentals	30%
Data-driven product discovery tactics	30%
Scaling product discovery	20%

TIPS TO PREPARE FOR THE EXAM

- ◆ This is an “open-book” exam, so be sure to have any notes you captured while taking the course beside you before beginning.
- ◆ The exam is timed without the ability to pause, so be sure you have a dedicated 60-minute period available before clicking “Start.”
- ◆ Make sure you have a quiet space so you can focus while taking the exam, with few distractions.
- ◆ Take your time to read exam questions carefully.
- ◆ We also ask that you please don’t cheat and don’t share exam content with others.

Good luck on the exam!

COURSE QUICK GUIDE

To help you prepare for the exam, below are some definitions, concepts, and frameworks you learned in the Product Discovery Certification Course.

MODULE 1: WELCOME TO THE PRODUCT DISCOVERY CERTIFICATION COURSE

Product discovery: The process of understanding customers' problems and needs, and then validating or rejecting solutions before development.

The foundation of all discovery work:

- **What customers do:** Users' behavior inside your application
- **How customers feel:** Users' sentiment based on their experience with your software
- **What customers want:** Users' feedback and feature requests that help inform what you build and what you improve

Five core tenets of successful product discovery:

1. User empathy
2. Collaboration
3. Prioritization
4. Measurement
5. Continuous learning

MODULE 2: WHY WE NEED TO GET PRODUCT DISCOVERY RIGHT

Continuous discovery: The process of gathering customer feedback and insights on an ongoing basis, rather than only at specific intervals.

Why discovery is critical for building software:

- Rapid evolution and adaptation
- Emphasis on user experience
- Data-driven insights

Four business outcomes you can impact with effective product discovery:

1. Customer retention
2. Revenue growth
3. Reduced costs
4. Risk mitigation

Cognitive bias: A systematic error in thinking that occurs when people process and interpret information in their surroundings, influencing their decisions and judgments.

Confirmation bias: When people seek out sources, points of view, and supporting materials that confirm their prior view or stance on an issue.

Bandwagon effect: When teams prioritize a point of view or direction based on the number of people voicing support for it.

Authority bias: When you privilege the opinions or judgements of someone in a position of authority and give them unmerited weight.

Four questions for data-driven product discovery:

1. What do customers want us to build and why?
2. Are users doing what we expect in the product? If not, why?
3. Where do different types of users fall off?
4. What do power users do differently?

MODULE 3: PRODUCT DISCOVERY FUNDAMENTALS

The Four Big Risks teams should aim to eliminate with discovery:

1. Value risk
2. Usability risk
3. Feasibility risk
4. Business viability risk

Product discovery framework:

- Part 1: Define the outcome
- Part 2: Understand users' problems
- Part 3: Identify the problem to solve
- Part 4: Explore possible solutions
- Part 5: Test and validate solutions
- Part 6: Close the loop

Tips for crafting effective discovery questions:

- Start with open-ended questions
- Avoid leading questions
- Stay focused on the customers' pain points
- Ask for specific examples
- Consider the context

Ten questions to ask during discovery:

1. What is your role and your most important tasks?
2. What are your current pain points?
3. How do you currently solve these pain points or needs?
4. What are the biggest challenges you encounter when trying to achieve X?
5. What would an ideal solution look like from your perspective?

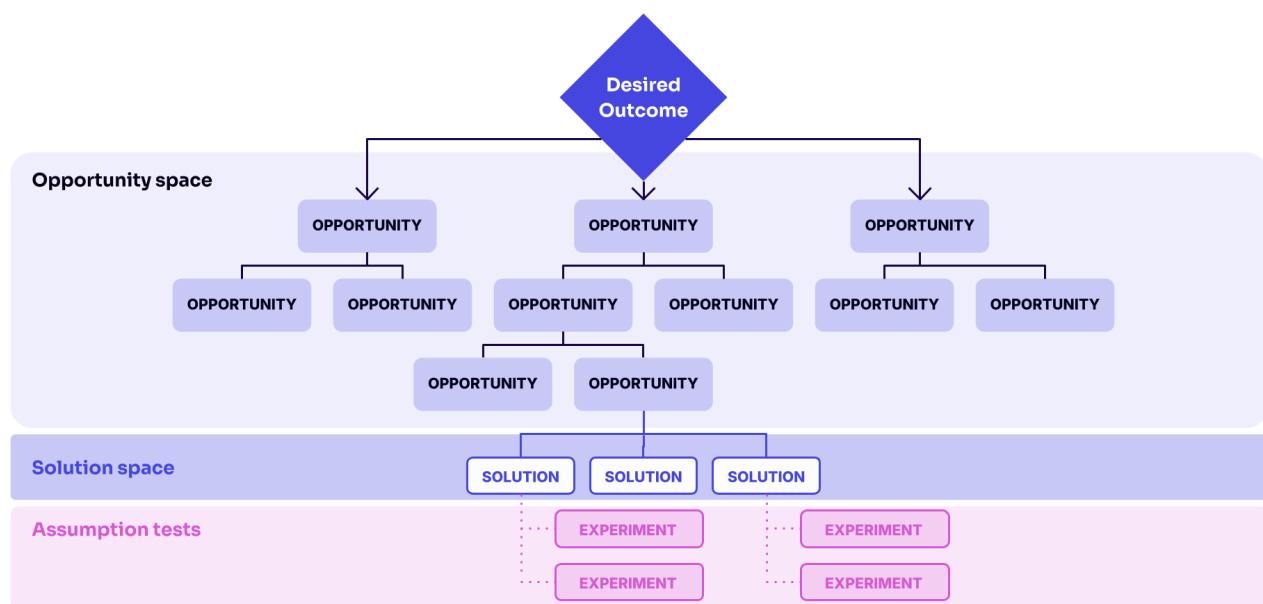
6. How easy is our product to use?
7. Are there any features you wish the product had?
8. If you could change one thing about our product, what would it be?
9. Are there any features that you don't find valuable or rarely use?
10. How has our product helped improve your business outcomes?

Jobs to Be Done: A framework that's based on the idea that people "hire" products in order to accomplish certain tasks or jobs. It focuses on the job that the customer is trying to accomplish rather than the product itself.

Empathy map: A collaborative visualization used to articulate what is known about a particular type of user, based on customer interviews and other forms of research.

User journey map: A visual representation of a user's experience with a product that shows the steps a user takes to achieve a goal.

Opportunity solution tree: A simple way of visually representing the paths you might take to reach a desired outcome.



Assumption mapping: A team brainstorming exercise that you can use to surface assumptions and risks in your product ideas. It involves plotting assumptions on two axes: certainty and importance.

Impact vs. effort matrix: A decision-making tool used to prioritize tasks, features, or projects based on their potential impact and the effort required to implement them.

RICE Score: A tool for prioritizing solutions during discovery that is based on four factors (Reach, Impact, Confidence, and Effort).

Principles for successful product discovery:

- Stay focused on your users
- Root product discovery in data
- Know your outcome
- Make discovery a team effort
- Product discovery never ends

MODULE 4: DATA-DRIVEN PRODUCT DISCOVERY TACTICS**Four types of data that can be used for discovery:**

1. Research
2. Customer feedback
3. Product analytics
4. Testing

How AI can help optimize product discovery:

- AI can help accelerate product discovery
- AI allows teams to include more inputs in their discovery data
- AI makes product discovery more continuous

User research: The process of gathering and analyzing information about software users to gain insights into their behaviors, needs, motivations, and preferences.

Generative user research: A type of user research that helps you understand the context that your users are in when they're encountering a problem, how much of a pain it is, what kind of solutions they've tried before, and how they're solving it now.

Types of generative user research:

- **User interviews:** One-on-one interviews where you ask open-ended questions to learn more about users and their wants, needs, and opinions of your product.
- **User surveys:** When teams collect input from a larger group of users in one swoop.

Competitive research: During discovery, it can show if competitors believe that a problem is worth solving, how they position their solutions, and what users think of these solutions.

Customer feedback: Qualitative data that provides a direct view into what your users think about and want from your product.

Benefits of collecting feedback in-app:

- You're able to ask for feedback while users are engaging with the product
- There is a higher likelihood that users will respond
- You can target the specific users from whom you want to collect feedback

Questions you can answer with customer feedback:

- What do customers want us to build and why?
- What are our users' current pain points?
- How easy is our product to use?

Product analytics: The act of capturing and analyzing how users interact with a digital product. Product analytics tools expose usage patterns from web and mobile applications via events, which are the actions users take within a product.

Friction: Anything that gets in the way of a user's ability to achieve their objective or job to be done.

Funnels: Allow you to measure how users move through a defined series of steps that you want them to follow.

Paths: Help you discover what users are doing before or after using a specific page or feature.

Session replay: Enables you to visually play back a user's session in your product.

Dashboard: A collection of reports and widgets about a particular topic or objective that helps fuel collaboration and inspire action.

Smoke test (fake door test): A way to help test the demand for a product or feature that doesn't exist yet using a minimal representation of the product.

Prototyping: When teams create preliminary product representations in order to validate concepts, test user interactions, and gather early feedback before implementing any full-scale development.

A/B test: Compares users' response to two versions of the product that are different in one single way.

Usability testing: Involves having people try using the product under the supervision and guidance of someone on the product or design team.

MODULE 5: SCALING PRODUCT DISCOVERY

Three types of gaps that can exist in your discovery practice:

1. Systematic gaps
2. Skill gaps
3. Insight gaps

Continuous discovery: Involves weekly touch points with customers by the team building the product, where they themselves conduct small research activities in pursuit of a desired outcome.

Four best practices for getting your company to adopt continuous discovery:

1. Educate your team
2. Start small
3. Demonstrate tangible value
4. Use established frameworks

Considerations when implementing continuous discovery:

- Leadership buy-in
- Flexibility
- Continuous improvement

Product-led discovery tactics:

- Delivering in-the-moment surveys based on specific user activity in the product
- Using in-app guides for research outreach
- Using in-app polls to validate ideas, test assumptions, and capture competitive intel
- Creating a mechanism for always-on in-app feedback collection

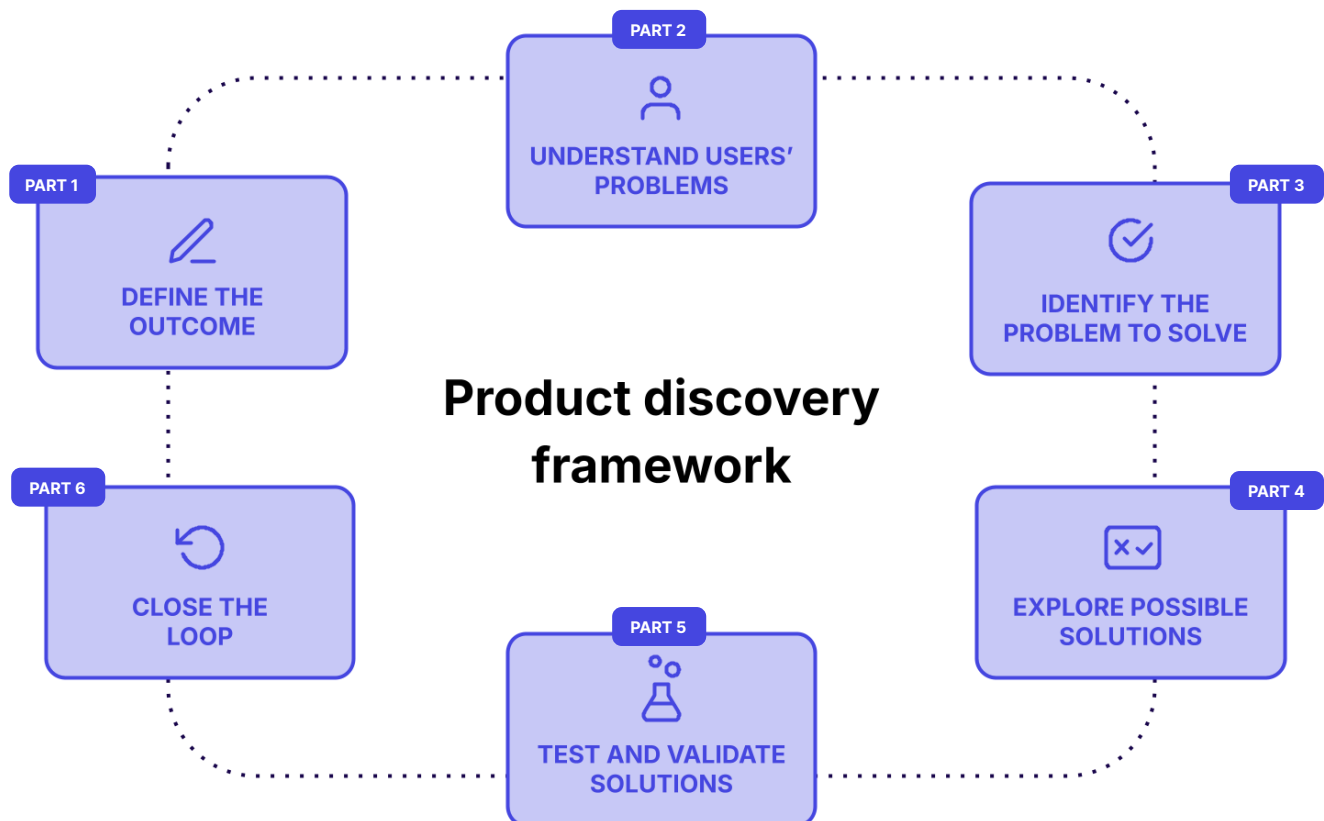
Tips for managing a successful discovery process:

- Ensure you have the right tools
- Use AI to accelerate discovery
- Have a way to measure success
- Establish clear communication channels

Five common discovery mistakes to avoid:

1. Excluding engineers or designers from the discovery process
2. Jumping to solutions before nailing down the problem
3. Only doing discovery pre-launch
4. Conducting research to validate existing assumptions
5. Skipping out on quantitative data

Product Discovery Framework



Part 1: Define the outcome

Determining the business goal you're looking to impact is key to driving meaningful product discovery.

Part 2: Understand users' problems

Spend time getting to know your users—and more specifically, their pain points.

Part 3: Identify the problem to solve

Use the inputs you've collected to determine the most pressing problem that when solved, will impact the outcome you identified in Part 1.

Part 4: Explore possible solutions

Come together as a team to ideate on different ways to solve the problem with your product.

Part 5: Test and validate solutions

The goal of this step is to come away with the solution that will move on to development and get added to the roadmap.

Part 6: Close the loop

Ensure product leadership and customer-facing teams know the results of your discovery efforts and communicate what users can expect in the product and how it addresses their needs.

Data-driven Product Discovery Checklist

Use this checklist to guide your product discovery efforts and help ensure you're leveraging the right data points throughout the process.

RESEARCH

During discovery, research helps you:

- Gather and analyze information about your users
- Gain insights into users' behaviors, needs, motivations, and preferences
- Understand the problems users are encountering



User Research

- ☐ User interviews
- ☐ In-app surveys



AI FOR USER RESEARCH:

Quickly learn about a new user type by asking questions about the specific persona's roles and responsibilities.



Competitive research



AI FOR COMPETITIVE RESEARCH:

Use AI tools to summarize reports, analyze trends, and pull information from competitors' websites at scale.

CUSTOMER FEEDBACK

During discovery, customer feedback helps you:

- Get a direct view into what users think about your product
- Learn what users want from your product



Proactively collect feedback

- ☐ In-app guides



Let users submit feedback at any time

- ☐ In-app feedback portal



AI FOR CUSTOMER FEEDBACK:

Analyze large amounts of feedback submissions related to specific features or product areas and extract common pain points and themes.

PRODUCT ANALYTICS

During discovery, product analytics helps you:

- Gain objective insights into user behavior, feature usage, and interaction patterns
- Validate hypotheses and identify product opportunities
- Reduce risk and ensure discovery is done in service of business impact



Understand users' problems by identifying friction

- ☐ Funnels
- ☐ Paths
- ☐ Session replay



Understand the breadth and depth of a problem

- ☐ Number of users experiencing friction
- ☐ Amount of ARR associated with those accounts



Centralize discovery data in a single place

- ☐ Dashboards

AI FOR PRODUCT ANALYTICS:



Analyze product usage data and pull out answers to discovery questions like: "Where are users dropping out of X workflow?"

TESTING

During discovery, testing helps you:

- Determine whether a solution is worth pursuing
- See how users react to a potential solution
- Decide which solution to move forward with



Smoke tests (fake door tests)



Prototyping

- ☐ In-app guides



A/B testing



Usability testing

AI FOR TESTING:



Leverage generative AI by providing prompts informed by customer and other data to quickly create a prototype that's ready to validate.

